

Complete model answers for all three EPC papers

Enhancing Professional Capacities

EPC-1 READING & TEXT

EPC-2 DRAMA & ARTS

EPC-3 ICT

38 MODEL ANSWERS

ENGLISH

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Full marks · 40 each Time · 3 hours Answer four or five ~8 to 10 marks each

This booklet gives a full, exam-ready model answer for every question that appeared in the three EPC (Enhancing Professional Capacities) papers of the B.Ed First Year internal examination at Madhepura, drawn from both the M.P. College of Education and T.P. College question papers. Each paper is of 40 marks and the student answers four or five questions, so every answer here is written at long-answer length, with a definition, a point-wise body and a short conclusion.

How to use this booklet

- Each paper below collects all its unique questions from both colleges, answered once in full.
- Write in your own words in the exam; use these answers for the structure, the key points and the examples.
- Every question is a long answer: aim for a definition, four to six explained points, an example, and a conclusion.

Contents

EPC-1. Reading and Reflecting on Text

Listening, reading and writing skills · text and textbook · home and school language · mother tongue

EPC-2. Drama and Arts in Education

Visual art · Mithila painting · craft · drama · music and dance · art in education

EPC-3. Critical Understanding of ICT

Computer · internet · software · educational technology · Flanders analysis · storage devices

I *Paper EPC-1 · Reading and Reflecting on Text*

Language, Reading & the Text

FULL MARKS 40

ANSWER ANY FOUR OR FIVE

ENGLISH

Q1

~8 MARKS

"Explain the importance of listening skills."

LISTENING

Listening is the active mental process of receiving, attending to, understanding and interpreting spoken language. It is the first of the four LSRW skills (Listening, Speaking, Reading, Writing) and the foundation on which the others are built.

Hearing is merely physical, but **listening is purposeful and conscious**. A child first listens, then speaks; only later does formal reading and writing develop. This is why listening is called the *primary receptive skill*.

Why listening skill is important

- **Base of language learning:** A child acquires its mother tongue almost entirely by listening to elders before it can read a single letter.
- **Develops speaking:** Correct pronunciation, accent, intonation and vocabulary are absorbed through careful listening. Poor listeners usually become poor speakers.

- **Improves comprehension:** In class the learner gathers most information by listening to the teacher; good listening means better understanding of lessons.
- **Aids concentration and attention:** Attentive listening trains the mind to focus, which helps memory and study.
- **Builds social and emotional bonds:** A patient listener understands others' feelings, which improves relationships and cooperation.
- **Essential for examinations and life:** Dictation, instructions, interviews and group discussions all depend on listening ability.

For example, a student who listens carefully to a maths explanation can solve a sum at once, while an inattentive listener repeats the same mistake. The teacher therefore uses stories, audio, rhymes and questioning to train listening.

Conclusion: Since speaking, reading and writing all grow out of listening, developing good listening skill is the first and most important duty of language education.

Q2

~8 MARKS

"What do you mean by 'text'? Describe the types of text."

TEXT

The word *text* comes from the Latin *textus*, meaning "that which is woven." A text is any meaningful piece of written or printed language (a passage, paragraph, story, poem or document) that conveys a complete idea to a reader.

In EPC-1, "reading and reflecting on text" means we read a text, understand its meaning, and respond to it thoughtfully. A text may be a single sentence or a whole book, but it must carry **connected meaning**.

Main types of text

Narrative text

- Tells a story or sequence of events.
- Has characters, plot and time order.
- Example: a folk tale, biography, novel.

Descriptive text

- Describes a person, place or object.
- Uses sensory and vivid words.
- Example: a description of the Himalayas.

Expository text

- Explains, informs or gives facts.
- Clear, logical and objective.
- Example: a science or history lesson.

Argumentative / Persuasive

- Presents a viewpoint with reasons.
- Tries to convince the reader.
- Example: an editorial, a debate speech.

Two further kinds are often added: **literary text** (poetry, drama, fiction that gives aesthetic pleasure) and **functional or non-literary text** (notices, advertisements, instructions, forms used in daily life).

Conclusion: A text is woven meaning in language, and recognising its type (narrative, descriptive, expository, argumentative, literary or functional) helps the reader read with the right purpose and depth.

Q3

~8 MARKS

"Discuss the principles of language teaching in the classroom."

PRINCIPLES OF LANGUAGE TEACHING

Principles of language teaching are the basic, tested guidelines that a teacher follows so that learners acquire a language naturally, correctly and with interest. They are drawn from psychology, linguistics and classroom experience.

Language is a skill, not merely knowledge, so it must be taught through use and practice. The following principles guide effective teaching.

- i. **Principle of habit formation:** Language is learnt by repetition and practice until correct use becomes a habit. Drills, dialogues and daily use help here.
- ii. **Naturalness:** Teach in the natural order, that is, listening and speaking before reading and writing, just as a child learns its mother tongue.
- iii. **Principle of motivation and interest:** Use stories, games, pictures and real situations so that learners feel eager to participate.
- iv. **Proceed from known to unknown and simple to complex:** Link new words and structures to what the child already knows.
- v. **Principle of oral work first:** Spoken practice precedes written work, because speech is the living form of language.
- vi. **Multi-skill (LSRW) balance:** Develop listening, speaking, reading and writing together, not in isolation.
- vii. **Principle of correctness and accuracy:** Provide correct models of pronunciation, grammar and usage, and gently correct errors.
- viii. **Learner-centred and activity-based:** The learner does, the teacher guides. Real communication is more useful than rote rules.

For example, while teaching the word "market," the teacher shows a picture, lets pupils speak about it, then they read and write the word, covering all four skills.

Conclusion: When a teacher respects these principles (habit, naturalness, motivation, graded difficulty and balanced LSRW practice), language teaching becomes meaningful and lasting.

Q4

~8 MARKS

"Describe the growth (development) of writing skill in a child."

WRITING SKILL

Writing is the productive skill of expressing thoughts through visible symbols (letters and words) in an organised form. It is the last of the four LSRW skills to develop and depends on the earlier growth of listening, speaking and reading.

Writing in a child does not appear suddenly; it grows gradually through clear stages of muscle control and meaning.

Stages in the growth of writing

- i. **Scribbling stage:** The very young child makes random marks and lines for the joy of movement. There is no meaning yet, but hand muscles begin to develop.
- ii. **Drawing and pre-writing stage:** The child draws shapes, circles and patterns, and starts holding the pencil correctly. Eye-hand coordination improves.
- iii. **Letter-formation stage:** The child copies and traces individual letters, learning their shape, size and direction.
- iv. **Word and copying stage:** Letters are joined to form words; the child copies words and short labels from the board.
- v. **Sentence-writing stage:** The child writes simple sentences on its own, with spacing, capitals and full stops.
- vi. **Composition stage:** Finally the child expresses original ideas in paragraphs, letters and short essays.

Several factors aid this growth: good fine-motor control, plenty of reading, correct models on the board, and praise that builds confidence. For example, a child first scribbles, then traces "A," then copies "apple," and at last writes "I ate an apple."

Conclusion: Writing develops step by step from scribbling to free composition, so the teacher should give graded practice and patience at each stage.

Q5

~10 MARKS

"Differentiate between home language and school language. (Write an essay on home language and school language.)"

HOME LANGUAGE VS SCHOOL LANGUAGE

Home language (mother tongue) is the language a child learns naturally at home from family. **School language** is the formal language used for teaching and learning in the classroom, which may differ from the home language.

Many Indian children speak one language at home (such as Maithili, Bhojpuri or Magahi) but study in Hindi or English at school. This gap, if ignored, can cause difficulty; if handled well, it makes the child multilingual.

Differences between Home Language and School Language

HOME LANGUAGE	SCHOOL LANGUAGE
Acquired naturally and informally from the family.	Learnt formally and consciously in the classroom.
Usually the mother tongue or dialect of the region.	The standard or official medium of instruction.
Used for daily talk, emotions and relationships.	Used for lessons, textbooks and examinations.
Mostly spoken; grammar is unconscious.	Spoken and written; grammar is taught consciously.
Vocabulary is limited to home and local life.	Vocabulary is wider and includes academic terms.
Learnt before the child comes to school.	Learnt after entering school.
Builds identity, comfort and confidence.	Builds wider knowledge and social mobility.

The NCF recommends starting education in the child's home language and gradually bridging to the school language, because a child understands best in the tongue it already knows. The teacher should respect the home language and use it as a stepping stone, not treat it as wrong.

Conclusion: Home language and school language are not enemies; a wise teacher links them so that the child moves smoothly from familiar speech to formal learning and becomes confidently multilingual.

Q6

~8 MARKS

"The medium of education should be the mother tongue. Discuss."

MOTHER TONGUE

The mother tongue is the first language a child learns from its mother and family, the language in which it naturally thinks, feels and dreams. Educationists strongly favour it as the medium of instruction, especially in the early years.

Great thinkers such as Gandhiji, Tagore and the Kothari Commission, and modern policy (NCF and NEP), all support mother-tongue education at the primary stage.

Why the mother tongue should be the medium

- **Easy understanding:** The child grasps new ideas quickly because it already knows the language. No energy is wasted on decoding a foreign tongue.
- **Natural expression:** The child can speak, ask and answer freely, which builds confidence and creativity.
- **Stronger foundation:** Clear basic concepts in the mother tongue make later learning of other subjects and languages easier.
- **Emotional security:** The familiar language reduces fear of school and keeps the child connected to family and culture.
- **Cultural preservation:** The mother tongue carries local values, literature and identity to the next generation.
- **Better participation:** Parents and community can help with studies when teaching is in the home language.

For example, a Maithili-speaking child understands a science concept far more easily when first explained in Maithili than directly in English. Other languages can then be added gradually.

Conclusion: Since the mother tongue gives the quickest, deepest and most joyful learning, it should be the medium of education at least in the early years, with other languages introduced step by step.

Q7

~8 MARKS

"Discuss the types and qualities of a good textbook."

TEXTBOOK

A textbook is a planned, printed book prepared according to a syllabus that presents the subject matter in a graded, organised way for the use of learners and teachers. It is one of the most important teaching aids in the classroom.

A good textbook guides both the teacher and the learner, supports self-study, and standardises what is taught across schools.

Types of textbook

By subject

- Language readers, mathematics, science, social science textbooks.

By level

- Primary, secondary and higher-level textbooks, graded by age.

By purpose

- Prescribed (course) books, supplementary readers, workbooks and reference books.

Qualities of a good textbook

- **Based on the syllabus and objectives:** It covers the prescribed course fully and aims at clear learning outcomes.
- **Suited to the learner's age and level:** Language and difficulty match the child's stage; it moves from simple to complex.
- **Accurate and up to date:** The content is correct, scientific and free from errors and bias.
- **Well organised:** Lessons are arranged logically with summaries, exercises and questions for practice.
- **Attractive and well produced:** Good print, illustrations, durable paper and a reasonable price.

- **Encourages thinking:** It includes activities and questions that promote reflection, not only rote memory.

For example, a good Class V reader uses simple stories, colourful pictures and exercises that make children read and think happily.

Conclusion: A textbook that is syllabus-based, learner-friendly, accurate, well organised and attractive becomes a true friend of both teacher and pupil.

Q8

~8 MARKS

"What do you mean by reading skills? Discuss its types."

READING

Reading is the receptive skill of recognising printed symbols and drawing meaning from them. True reading is not just decoding words but understanding, interpreting and reflecting on the text. It is the third of the four LSRW skills.

Reading is a key to all knowledge, because most learning after the early years comes through the printed word. It involves the eyes, the mind and prior knowledge working together.

Types of reading

Loud (oral) reading

- Reading aloud with correct pronunciation and pause.
- Useful for beginners and for teaching speech.

Silent reading

- Reading with the eyes and mind only.
- Faster, and gives better comprehension.

Intensive reading

- Careful, detailed reading of a short text.
- Aims at full understanding of every point.

Extensive reading

- Wide reading of long texts for pleasure.
- Builds fluency, vocabulary and the reading habit.

Two more techniques are **skimming** (rapid reading to get the general idea) and **scanning** (quick searching for a particular fact, like a name in a list). A skilled reader uses the right type for the right purpose.

Conclusion: Reading means getting meaning from print, and a good reader commands loud, silent, intensive and extensive reading along with skimming and scanning to read with speed and understanding.

Q9

~8 MARKS

"Throw light on the nature of Indian languages."

INDIAN LANGUAGES

India is a vast multilingual country with hundreds of languages and thousands of dialects. The Constitution recognises 22 scheduled languages, and Hindi (in Devanagari) is the official language of the Union, while each State may use its own.

Understanding the nature of Indian languages helps the teacher respect the learner's home tongue and teach in a multilingual setting.

Nature of Indian languages

- **Great diversity:** Many languages belong to four main families: Indo-Aryan (Hindi, Bengali, Maithili), Dravidian (Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam), Austro-Asiatic (Santali) and Tibeto-Burman.
- **Rich literary heritage:** Sanskrit, Tamil, Bengali and others have ancient and respected literatures.
- **Common script base:** Most North Indian scripts grew from the Brahmi script, so many share similar sounds and symbols.
- **Phonetic writing:** Indian scripts are largely phonetic; words are mostly written as they are spoken.

- **Mutual influence:** Indian languages have borrowed freely from Sanskrit, Persian, Arabic and English, sharing much vocabulary.
- **Multilingual society:** Most Indians naturally speak two or three languages, which makes multilingualism a strength, as the NCF notes.

For example, a child in Bihar may speak Maithili at home, study in Hindi, and learn English at school, all without confusion. The three-language formula was framed to manage this diversity in education.

Conclusion: Indian languages are diverse yet deeply connected, rich in literature and mostly phonetic; this multilingual nature is a national treasure that the teacher should use as a resource.

Q10

~8 MARKS

"Discuss the role of the language teacher in the classroom."

THE LANGUAGE TEACHER

The language teacher is the guide, model and motivator who helps learners develop the four skills of listening, speaking, reading and writing. In language teaching the teacher's own use of language is itself the main teaching aid.

Since language is learnt mainly by imitation and practice, the teacher plays many roles at once in the classroom.

Roles of the language teacher

- **As a model:** The teacher provides correct pronunciation, accent and usage that pupils imitate, so the teacher's own language must be correct and clear.
- **As a guide and facilitator:** Rather than only lecturing, the teacher creates situations, asks questions and lets learners use the language themselves.
- **As a motivator:** Through stories, games, praise and interesting material, the teacher keeps learners eager and removes the fear of mistakes.
- **As a planner:** The teacher prepares graded lessons, teaching aids and activities suited to the learners' level.
- **As an evaluator:** The teacher observes, corrects errors gently and assesses progress in all four skills.
- **As a resource and friend:** The teacher answers doubts, encourages reading and respects each child's home language.

For example, while teaching a poem, the teacher reads it aloud as a model, explains hard words, lets pupils recite, and praises their effort, thus modelling, guiding and motivating in one lesson.

Conclusion: The language teacher is at once a model, guide, motivator, planner and evaluator; the success of language learning depends largely on how well these roles are played.

Q11

~8 MARKS

*"How do reading skills affect (influence) personality?
Discuss."*

READING AND PERSONALITY

Personality is the total of a person's thoughts, feelings, behaviour and character. Reading, the skill of drawing meaning from text, is one of the most powerful forces that shape and enrich personality.

Sir Francis Bacon said, "Reading maketh a full man." A reader meets many ideas, lives and cultures through books, and this steadily moulds the whole person.

How reading influences personality

- **Develops knowledge and the mind:** Wide reading increases information, sharpens thinking and makes a person well informed and confident.
- **Improves language and expression:** Reading enriches vocabulary and style, so the reader speaks and writes impressively, which improves social personality.
- **Builds character and values:** Good books on great lives and morals inspire honesty, courage and kindness.
- **Widens outlook and tolerance:** Reading about other cultures and viewpoints makes a person broad-minded and sympathetic.
- **Develops imagination and creativity:** Stories and poetry stir the imagination and creative power.
- **Gives emotional balance and recreation:** Reading is a healthy hobby that relieves stress and provides joy, making the person calm and cheerful.

For example, a student who regularly reads biographies and good literature usually grows into a confident, articulate and disciplined individual, while a non-reader's outlook often stays narrow.

Conclusion: Reading shapes the mind, language, character and emotions together, so the habit of good reading is one of the surest ways to build a strong and

2

Paper EPC-2 · Drama and Arts in Education

Drama, Art & Aesthetics

FULL MARKS 40

ANSWER ANY FOUR OR FIVE

ENGLISH

Q1

~10 MARKS

"What do you understand by Visual art? Describe it in detail and explain how you will use it in the classroom."

VISUAL ART

Visual art is that branch of fine art which is perceived mainly through the eyes. It includes all forms in which an artist gives shape to ideas, feelings and beauty using line, colour, form and texture on a surface or in space, for example drawing, painting and sculpture.

The word *visual* means related to sight. Hence visual art is the art we look at rather than listen to. It is a permanent or static art, unlike performing art, because the finished work remains fixed and can be seen again and again.

Main features explained

- **Appeals to the eye:** it communicates through visible elements like colour and shape, not through sound or movement.
- **Uses basic elements:** line, shape, colour, tone, space and texture are the building blocks the artist arranges.
- **Expresses emotion and idea:** a single painting can express joy, sorrow or devotion without a single word.
- **Is creative and original:** each work reflects the imagination of its maker.

How I will use visual art in the classroom

- i. Use **charts, pictures and diagrams** to make difficult lessons (a plant cell, a map) easy and memorable.
- ii. Ask pupils to **draw and colour** what they learn, so they understand it actively and develop fine motor skills.
- iii. Display a **class art board** of pupils' work to build confidence and a sense of beauty.
- iv. Use **clay modelling and collage** to teach shapes, numbers and craft together.

Thus visual art is a powerful, eye centred means of expression. Used well, it makes teaching lively, develops creativity and aesthetic sense, and helps every child express what words cannot.

Q2

~8 MARKS

"Describe the different types of Visual art."

MEANING

Visual art is art seen by the eye. It is broadly divided into many **types or forms** according to the technique, tools and material the artist uses.

Major types of visual art

Drawing

- The base of all visual art.
- Made with pencil, charcoal, pen or crayon using **lines**.
- Example: a sketch or a line diagram.

Painting

- Use of **colour** on a surface (paper, canvas, wall).
- Types: water colour, oil, fresco, folk painting.
- Example: Madhubani painting.

Sculpture

- Art in **three dimensions**, having length, width and depth.
- Made by carving stone, casting metal or modelling clay.
- Example: the Sarnath Buddha statue.

Printmaking

- An image is cut on a block or plate and **printed many times**.
- Includes woodcut, etching and screen printing.
- Example: block printed cloth designs.

Photography and other forms

- **Photography**: capturing real images through a camera, a modern visual art.
- **Architecture**: the art of designing beautiful buildings.
- **Calligraphy and graphic design** are also counted as visual arts today.

In short, drawing, painting, sculpture, printmaking and photography are the chief types of visual art, each using its own medium to create beauty and meaning.

Q3

~8 MARKS

"Describe the characteristics of Mithila (Madhubani) painting."

MADHUBANI / MITHILA ART

Madhubani (also called Mithila) painting is a famous **folk painting** of the Mithila region of Bihar. Traditionally done by women on the walls and floors of homes during festivals and weddings, it is now world famous and a pride of Bihar.

Main characteristics

- **Natural colours and dyes**: colours are made from plants, flowers, turmeric, soot and other natural sources, giving bright, earthy tones.
- **Double line (outline) work**: figures are first drawn in a clear **double line border** and then filled in.

- **No empty space:** a special feature is that **no part of the surface is left blank**; gaps are filled with flowers, leaves, dots and geometric patterns.
- **Themes of nature and religion:** subjects are gods and goddesses (Ram-Sita, Radha-Krishna, Durga), the sun, moon, fish, peacock, lotus and scenes of marriage.
- **Use of simple tools:** earlier made with twigs, matchsticks and fingers; cotton wrapped nibs and brushes are used now.
- **Symbolic and auspicious:** symbols like the fish, parrot and lotus stand for fertility, love and prosperity.

Styles

It has well known styles such as *Bharni* (filled with colour), *Kachni* (fine line work), *Godna* and *Tantrik*, each with its own look.

Thus Madhubani painting, with its natural dyes, double lines, fully filled surface and themes of nature and the divine, is a living folk treasure that gives Bihar a unique cultural identity.

Q4

~8 MARKS

"What is the role of a teacher in performing-art teaching?"

PERFORMING ART

Performing art is the art presented **live before an audience** through the artist's own body and voice, mainly **drama, music and dance**.

The teacher here is not only an instructor but a guide, director and motivator.

Roles of the teacher

- **Motivator:** the teacher removes shyness and stage fear and encourages every child to take part with confidence.
- **Guide and demonstrator:** the teacher shows correct posture, voice, rhythm (tala) and expression (bhav) by performing the action first.
- **Director:** like a play's director, the teacher plans the performance, assigns roles and arranges rehearsals.
- **Trainer of skills:** the teacher patiently develops breath control, sense of rhythm, body movement and clear speech.

- **Identifier of talent:** the teacher spots hidden ability in singing, acting or dancing and gives it a chance to grow.
- **Creator of environment:** arranges a stage, costumes, music and a free atmosphere so children can express themselves.

Other duties

- Acts as a **good role model**, since children copy the teacher's expression and discipline.
- Gives **positive feedback** instead of harsh criticism, so interest is kept alive.
- Links the art to **culture and values**, making learning meaningful.

In short, in performing art the teacher is a friend, guide, director and motivator who develops both the skill and the confidence of the learner.

Q5

~8 MARKS

"Introduce the One-act play (*ekanki*)."

ONE-ACT PLAY (EKANKI)

A one-act play, called *ekanki* in Hindi, is a **short drama complete in a single act**. Like a short story among stories, it presents one main incident and reaches its climax and conclusion quickly, usually within an hour of performance.

Main features

- **Single act and single plot:** there is only one act centred on one event, with no sub plots.
- **Unity of time, place and action:** the whole story unfolds in one place and a short span of time.
- **Few characters:** only a small number of characters are used, all linked to the main theme.
- **Quick start and rising tension:** it begins straight at the point of conflict and moves fast to a sharp climax.
- **One central idea or message:** it conveys a single thought, emotion or social message.
- **Brevity:** it is short, so it holds the audience's attention from start to end.

Importance in education

The one-act play is very useful in school because it is short, easy to stage and needs few actors and little material. It develops speech, confidence, team spirit and creativity in pupils. *Dhruvswamini* and the ekankis of Bhuvaneshwar and Ramkumar Verma are well known examples.

Thus the ekanki is a compact, powerful dramatic form that delivers a complete experience in one act and is ideal for classroom use.

Q6

~10 MARKS

"What is the meaning of Craft art? Describe its nature, importance and types."

CRAFT ART

Craft art (handicraft) means making **useful and beautiful objects by hand and skill**, often from simple local materials. Unlike fine art, which is made mainly to be admired, craft joins **utility with beauty**, for example pottery, weaving and basket making.

Nature of craft art

- **Hand made:** it depends on the skill of the hand and not only on machines.
- **Useful and beautiful:** the product serves a purpose in daily life and also looks attractive.
- **Local and traditional:** it uses materials available nearby (clay, bamboo, wool) and passes from one generation to the next.
- **Practical skill based:** it grows through practice, patience and fine hand work.

Importance

- Develops **fine motor skills, patience and concentration** in children.
- Provides **self employment and income**, supporting the rural economy.
- Preserves **culture and tradition** and keeps old skills alive.
- Teaches **dignity of labour** and the joy of creating with one's own hands.

Types of craft

By material

- Pottery and clay work
- Wood and bamboo craft
- Metal and jewellery craft

By technique

- Weaving and textile (cloth, carpet)
- Embroidery and stitching
- Basketry, paper craft and toy making

Thus craft art is the skilled hand work of making useful, beautiful objects. It builds skill, earns livelihood and protects our cultural heritage.

Q7

~10 MARKS

"Explain the fundamental differences between Indian and Western art traditions."

CONTEXT

Both Indian and Western art are great traditions, but they grew from different outlooks on life. Indian art is mainly **spiritual and symbolic**, while Western art is mainly **realistic and scientific**.

Fundamental differences between Indian and Western art

BASIS	INDIAN ART TRADITION	WESTERN ART TRADITION
Aim	Spiritual; seeks the inner soul and the divine (moksha).	Realistic; shows the outer, material world as it appears.
Approach	Symbolic and imaginative; uses signs and idealised forms.	Scientific and natural; copies real nature accurately.
Perspective	Little use of linear perspective; space is shown flat or symbolically.	Strong use of <i>perspective</i> , light and shade to create depth.
Subject	Gods, goddesses, religion, nature and mythology.	Human beings, portraits, landscapes and real life scenes.
Form of figure	Idealised and graceful, expressing emotion (bhava) and mood (rasa).	Anatomically correct and lifelike, true to the human body.
Example	Ajanta cave paintings, Madhubani, temple sculpture.	Works of Leonardo da Vinci and Michelangelo, oil portraits.

Conclusion

In short, Indian art looks inward and aims at the spirit through symbol and idealised beauty, while Western art looks outward and aims at realism through perspective and scientific accuracy. Both are valuable expressions of human creativity, each rich in its own way.

Q8

~8 MARKS

"Describe the competencies developed in students through the creative forms of art."

MEANING

The creative forms of art (drawing, painting, music, dance, drama and craft) do far more than entertain. They develop many competencies, that is skills and abilities, that help in a child's all round growth.

Competencies developed

- **Creativity and imagination:** art frees the child to think in new ways and create original work.
- **Self expression:** a child expresses feelings and ideas that cannot be put into words, through colour, sound or movement.
- **Motor and physical skills:** drawing, modelling and dance sharpen **fine and gross motor coordination** and hand-eye control.
- **Aesthetic sense:** the child learns to appreciate beauty, harmony, colour and rhythm.
- **Emotional development:** art gives a healthy outlet to emotions and builds patience and calm.
- **Concentration and observation:** finishing a piece of art needs focus and careful looking.
- **Social skills:** group activities like a play or chorus build cooperation, team spirit and confidence.

Higher abilities

- **Problem solving:** deciding colours, design or composition trains the mind to make choices.
- **Cultural awareness:** folk art and music connect the child to heritage and values.

Thus the creative arts develop the head, the heart and the hand together: creativity, expression, motor skills, aesthetic sense and emotional balance, making art an essential part of complete education.

Q9

~10 MARKS

"Throw light on the art, craft and architecture of the Gupta period and the medieval period."

CONTEXT

The **Gupta period** (roughly 4th to 6th century CE) is called the *Golden Age* of Indian art, while the **medieval period** saw the rise of grand **Indo-Islamic architecture**. Both left a rich heritage.

Art and craft of the Gupta period

- **Painting:** the famous **Ajanta cave paintings**, showing the life of Buddha, reached their peak, full of grace and colour.
- **Sculpture:** the serene **Sarnath Buddha** statue is a masterpiece of balance and calm expression.
- **Architecture:** the first stone temples (the Dashavatara temple at Deogarh) and the rust free **iron pillar of Delhi** show great skill.
- **Craft:** fine work in gold coins, terracotta, ivory and textiles flourished.

Art and architecture of the medieval period

- **Indo-Islamic style:** a blend of Indian and Islamic features gave the **arch, dome, minaret** and beautiful gardens.
- **Great monuments:** the Qutub Minar, the forts and tombs of the Sultanate, and Mughal wonders like the **Taj Mahal, Red Fort and Fatehpur Sikri**.
- **Painting:** the rich **Mughal miniature** and Rajput painting traditions developed.
- **Craft:** marble inlay (pietra dura), carpet weaving and fine jewellery reached new heights.

The rock cut caves of **Ellora** bridge the two ages with their grand carving. Together, the Gupta and medieval periods gave India some of the world's finest art, sculpture and architecture, a heritage we still admire today.

Q10

~8 MARKS

"Describe the importance of art in human life."

MEANING

Art is the creative expression of human feelings, ideas and beauty. It has been part of life since the cave paintings of early man. Art is not a luxury but a basic need that makes life beautiful and meaningful.

Importance of art

- **Means of expression:** art lets a person express joy, sorrow and love that words alone cannot convey.
- **Develops creativity:** it trains the mind to imagine and create new things.
- **Gives joy and peace:** seeing or making art relaxes the mind and removes stress.
- **Builds aesthetic sense:** art teaches us to recognise and love beauty in life and nature.
- **Preserves culture:** folk art, music and dance carry our traditions and values to the next generation.
- **Emotional balance:** art is a healthy outlet for emotions, helping mental health.

In society and livelihood

- Art **unites people** at festivals and ceremonies and strengthens social bonds.
- It provides **employment** to crafts persons, painters, singers and dancers.
- In education it makes **learning enjoyable** and develops the whole personality.

Thus art enriches human life by giving expression, creativity, joy, beauty and identity. A life without art would be dull; art is truly the soul of a civilisation.

Q11

~8 MARKS

"Write the definition of drama and describe the role of drama in education."

DRAMA

Drama is a form of performing art in which a story is presented on a stage through action, dialogue and characters before an audience. It shows life by imitating it. In short, drama is "life acted out", combining acting, speech, music and movement.

Role of drama in education

- **Active learning:** when pupils act out a lesson (a historical event or a story), they understand and remember it far better.
- **Develops language and speech:** dialogue delivery improves pronunciation, vocabulary and fluency.
- **Builds confidence:** performing on stage removes shyness and stage fear.
- **Develops emotion and empathy:** by playing a character, a child learns to feel and understand others' emotions.
- **Encourages teamwork:** a play needs many pupils to cooperate, building social skills and discipline.
- **Develops creativity:** writing scripts, designing sets and costumes sparks imagination.

Moral and cultural value

- Drama can teach **moral values** and social messages in an enjoyable way.
- It connects pupils to their **culture and traditions**.

Thus drama is acted life, and in education it is a powerful tool that makes learning lively while developing language, confidence, emotion, creativity and cooperation in students.

Q12

~8 MARKS

"As a teacher, what methods of teaching drama will you use in school?"

APPROACH

To teach drama well, a teacher should make it **active, joyful and free from fear**. Several practical methods can be used so that every child takes part and learns by doing.

Methods of teaching drama

Role play

- Pupils take on roles (king, farmer, mother) and act out a situation.
- Builds empathy and understanding of others.

Improvisation

- Children act a scene on the spot without a fixed script.
- Develops quick thinking and creativity.

Script reading

- Reading a play aloud with proper tone and expression.
- Improves reading, pronunciation and understanding of characters.

Mime

- Acting using only **body movement and gesture**, without words.
- Develops expression and body language.

Other useful methods

- **Dramatization:** turning a lesson, story or poem into a small play to teach the topic.
- **Puppet play:** shy children speak freely through puppets.
- **Demonstration:** the teacher performs first, then pupils copy and improve.

By combining role play, improvisation, script reading, mime and dramatization, I will make drama enjoyable and develop confidence, language and creativity in my pupils.

"Briefly describe the development of classical music in India and the usefulness of music in education."

INDIAN CLASSICAL MUSIC

Indian classical music is one of the oldest in the world. Its roots lie in the **Samaveda**, whose hymns were sung. It is built on two pillars: **raga** (the melodic framework) and **tala** (the rhythmic cycle).

Development of classical music

- **Vedic origin:** music began with the chanting of the Samaveda.
- **Classical texts:** sage Bharata's *Natyashastra* and Sharangadeva's *Sangeet Ratnakara* set the theory of raga and tala.
- **Two main systems:** over time it split into **Hindustani music** (North India) and **Carnatic music** (South India).
- **Great names:** Tansen, Amir Khusrau and Swami Haridas enriched the tradition, which lives on today through many gharanas.

Usefulness of music in education

- **Aids memory:** facts learnt in song form (tables, alphabet, rhymes) are remembered easily.
- **Develops concentration and discipline:** learning raga and tala needs focus and regular practice.
- **Emotional balance:** music calms the mind, reduces stress and lifts the mood.
- **Builds aesthetic sense and culture:** it teaches appreciation of beauty and connects pupils to heritage.
- **Improves language and breathing:** singing improves pronunciation, rhythm and breath control.

Thus Indian classical music, born from the Samaveda and grown into the Hindustani and Carnatic systems of raga and tala, is a great heritage. In education, music sharpens memory, focus and emotion, making it a valuable aid to learning.

Q14

~8 MARKS

"Mention the creative development in children through songs and music."

MEANING

Songs and music are a natural delight for children. Beyond joy, they play a strong part in **creative and all round development**, especially at an early age.

Creative development through songs and music

- **Imagination and creativity:** songs about animals, nature and stories awaken a child's imagination and invite them to make up their own tunes and actions.
- **Language development:** rhymes and songs build vocabulary, clear pronunciation and a sense of rhythm in speech.
- **Self expression:** children freely express feelings of joy, love or excitement through singing.
- **Memory and learning:** lessons set to music (counting songs, the alphabet) are learnt quickly and remembered long.
- **Physical development:** action songs with clapping and movement develop motor coordination.
- **Emotional growth:** music soothes, builds confidence and gives a healthy outlet to emotions.

Social and aesthetic value

- **Social skills:** singing in a group teaches cooperation, sharing and turn taking.
- **Aesthetic sense:** children begin to enjoy melody, harmony and beauty of sound.

Thus songs and music nurture imagination, language, expression, memory and emotion in children. They make the early years joyful and lay a strong base for creative and balanced growth.

Q15

~10 MARKS

"Describe any folk dance of your state (Bihar) and show its educational importance."

BIHAR FOLK DANCE

Bihar is rich in folk dances such as **Jat-Jatin**, **Bidesia**, **Jhijhian**, **Paika** and **Domkach**. Here we describe **Jat-Jatin**, a popular folk dance of the Mithila and north Bihar region.

About Jat-Jatin

- **Performers:** it is performed by a couple, *Jat* (the husband) and *Jatin* (the wife), often during the rainy season and on moonlit nights.
- **Theme:** it tells the story of the love, quarrels and separation of a married couple, reflecting village life and emotions.
- **Style:** it combines song, dialogue and graceful movement, accompanied by the dholak and other folk instruments.
- **Social message:** it touches on themes like the pain of separation when men migrate for work, drought and family life.

Bidesia (by Bhikhari Thakur) shows migration too; Jhijhian is a prayer dance for rain; Paika is a martial dance with swords; Domkach is sung at weddings.

Educational importance

- **Cultural awareness:** pupils learn the traditions, dress and music of their own region and feel pride in their heritage.
- **Physical development:** the dance develops body coordination, rhythm and grace.
- **Emotional and social growth:** performing in a group builds cooperation, confidence and an understanding of social issues.
- **Creativity and joy:** it makes learning lively and develops the aesthetic sense.

Thus Jat-Jatin, like other Bihar folk dances, is not only entertainment but a living lesson in culture, emotion and social life that enriches education and keeps our heritage alive.

Computers, ICT & Education

FULL MARKS 40

ANSWER ANY FOUR OR FIVE

ENGLISH

Q1

~10 MARKS

"What is a computer? Describe its characteristics and its utility in the teaching and learning process."

COMPUTER

A computer is an electronic device that accepts **data** as input, processes it according to a set of instructions (a program), and produces meaningful **information** as output, which it can also store for future use. The word comes from *compute*, meaning to calculate.

Characteristics of a computer

- **Speed:** A computer performs millions of operations in a single second, far faster than any human being. Its speed is measured in milliseconds, microseconds and nanoseconds.
- **Accuracy:** It gives error-free results. Mistakes usually arise from wrong data fed by the user (this is called GIGO, Garbage In Garbage Out), not from the machine itself.
- **Storage:** It can store a very large amount of data, pictures, audio and video permanently in its memory and retrieve any item instantly when required.
- **Automation:** Once a program is given, a computer carries out the whole task on its own without repeated human help.
- **Versatility:** The same machine can do many different jobs, such as typing a letter, playing a video, solving sums and browsing the internet.
- **Diligence:** It works continuously for hours without getting tired, bored or losing concentration.

Utility in teaching and learning

- It makes lessons interesting through animation, pictures and sound (multimedia).

- It supports **Computer Assisted Instruction (CAI)** so that a learner can study at his or her own pace.
- Teachers prepare notes, question papers, results and presentations quickly.
- It opens access to e-books, online courses and the whole internet for self-study.

In short, the computer is a fast, accurate and tireless machine that has become an indispensable tool of modern education.

Q2

~10 MARKS

"What is the Internet? Describe how you can use the internet on your PC, and discuss learning through the internet."

INTERNET

The Internet (a short form of *Inter-connected Network*) is a worldwide network that links millions of computers together so that they can share information and communicate. It is often called the **network of networks**.

How to use the internet on your PC

- Get a connection from an **Internet Service Provider (ISP)** through broadband, a SIM-based dongle or Wi-Fi.
- Open a **web browser** such as Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox or Microsoft Edge.
- Type a web address (URL) or use a **search engine** like Google to find the website you need.
- Visit pages on the **World Wide Web (WWW)**, send and receive **email**, and download files.

Common internet services

- **WWW:** the huge collection of linked web pages that we read and view.
- **Email:** fast electronic exchange of letters and documents.
- **Search engines:** tools that locate information from across the web.
- **Social media and video calls:** for sharing and communication.

Learning through the internet

- **E-learning:** lessons, videos and quizzes are studied online anytime, anywhere.
- **MOOCs:** Massive Open Online Courses such as SWAYAM, Coursera and edX offer free or low-cost courses to thousands of learners at once.
- **Online libraries and e-books** give endless reading material.
- **Webinars and recorded classes** allow distance education.

Thus the internet has become a vast, low-cost classroom that supports both teaching and lifelong self-learning.

Q3

~8 MARKS

"Describe the importance of computers in education, and outline computer education in schools."

COMPUTER EDUCATION

Computer education means teaching students the knowledge and skills of using a computer, and also using the computer as a tool to teach other subjects more effectively.

Importance of computers in education

- **Better understanding:** animations, diagrams and videos make difficult ideas easy to grasp.
- **Individual learning:** through CAI a learner moves at his or her own speed.
- **Storehouse of knowledge:** e-books, online notes and the internet give unlimited information.
- **Administrative help:** admissions, attendance, examinations and results are managed quickly.
- **Skill for the future:** computer literacy is now a basic requirement for almost every job.
- **Distance and online education:** learners in remote areas can study without travelling.

Computer education in schools (outline)

Primary stage

- Basic awareness, parts of a computer.
- Simple typing and drawing programs.
- Friendly, game-based learning.

Secondary & higher stage

- Operating systems and MS Office.
- Internet use and basic programming.
- Project work and ICT in subjects.

Hence computers have become central to both learning and school management, and computer education must begin early and grow stage by stage.

Q4

~8 MARKS

"Write a note on (and an essay on) computer software: its usage and evaluation."

SOFTWARE

Software is the set of programs, instructions and data that tells the computer what to do. Unlike hardware (the physical parts), software cannot be touched; it is the soul that makes the body of hardware work.

Types of software

System software

- Runs and controls the machine.
- Examples: Windows, Linux, Android (operating systems).

Application software

- Does specific user jobs.
- Examples: MS Word, Excel, browsers, educational apps.

Usage of software

- Writing and printing documents (word processors).
- Calculations, accounts and data tables (spreadsheets).
- Presentations and teaching (PowerPoint, multimedia).
- Educational uses through **CAI** and subject-based learning apps.

Evaluation of educational software

- **Content accuracy:** the matter must be correct and suited to the syllabus.
- **Ease of use:** simple, clear and user-friendly screens.
- **Interactivity:** the learner should be active, not just a viewer.
- **Feedback:** it should show right and wrong answers.
- **Cost and system needs:** affordable and able to run on available machines.

Good software, carefully chosen and evaluated, turns the computer into a powerful and reliable teaching aid.

Q5

~8 MARKS

"Describe the limits (limitations) of Information and Communication Technology (ICT)."

ICT

Information and Communication Technology (ICT) means all the tools, such as computers, the internet, mobiles and multimedia, used to collect, store, process and share information. Despite its great value, ICT has several limitations.

Limitations of ICT

- **High cost:** computers, software, internet and their upkeep are expensive, which poor schools and families cannot easily afford.
- **Digital divide:** a wide gap exists between those who have access to ICT (mostly urban, richer people) and those who do not (rural and poor areas).
- **Lack of human touch:** a machine cannot give the love, moral guidance and personal care that a real teacher provides.
- **Technical faults:** power cuts, virus attacks, breakdowns and weak internet can stop teaching at any moment.

- **Distraction and misuse:** learners may waste time on games, social media or harmful content instead of studying.
- **Health problems:** long screen time causes eye strain, headache and poor posture.
- **Need for training:** many teachers and students still do not know how to use ICT properly.

ICT is a powerful servant but a poor master; its limits remind us that technology must support, and never fully replace, the human teacher.

Q6

~8 MARKS

"What do you understand by a computer virus? Write a note on protection from computer viruses and the maintenance of a computer."

COMPUTER VIRUS

A computer virus is a harmful program that enters a computer without permission, copies itself, and damages files, slows the system or steals data. It spreads through infected pen drives, downloads, email attachments and the internet.

Common types of malicious programs

- **Worm:** spreads by itself through networks.
- **Trojan horse:** hides inside a useful-looking program.
- **Ransomware:** locks files and demands money.
- **Spyware:** secretly watches and steals information.

Protection from viruses

- Install good **antivirus software** (such as Quick Heal, Avast or Windows Defender) and update it regularly.
- Scan every pen drive and downloaded file before use.
- Do not open unknown email attachments or doubtful links.
- Keep the operating system and software updated, and use a firewall.
- Keep regular **backups** of important data.

Maintenance of a computer

- Keep the system clean and free from dust, and ensure proper ventilation.
- Use a UPS or voltage stabiliser to guard against power problems.
- Delete temporary files and run disk clean-up to free space.
- Shut down the computer properly and handle it carefully.

Thus, with a good antivirus, careful habits and regular maintenance, a computer can be kept safe, fast and long-lasting.

Q7

~8 MARKS

"What do you understand by educational technology? Throw light on its needs and objectives."

EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY

Educational technology is the scientific and systematic application of knowledge, methods, tools and media to make teaching and learning more effective, easy and economical. It is not only machines but also the planned use of techniques in education.

Need for educational technology

- **Population pressure:** it helps teach large numbers of learners at once.
- **Knowledge explosion:** it organises and delivers the ever-growing store of knowledge.
- **Quality teaching:** it makes lessons clear, interesting and effective.
- **Individual differences:** it allows learning at one's own pace.
- **Distance education:** it reaches learners in remote areas.

Objectives of educational technology

- To improve the quality of teaching and learning.
- To identify the needs of the learner and the community.
- To make best use of teaching aids and media.
- To make learning interesting, meaningful and lasting.
- To help the teacher manage the class and evaluate learners scientifically.
- To save time, money and effort in education.

In short, educational technology applies science to teaching so that education becomes better, wider and more efficient.

Q8

~10 MARKS

"What do you mean by Interaction Analysis? Discuss Flanders' Interaction Analysis Category System (FIACS)."

INTERACTION ANALYSIS

Interaction analysis is a technique of observing and recording the verbal behaviour (the talk) that goes on between a teacher and pupils in the classroom, so that the teacher can study and improve his or her own teaching.

Flanders' Interaction Analysis Category System (FIACS)

Developed by **Ned A. Flanders**, this system divides all classroom talk into **ten categories**: seven for teacher talk, two for pupil talk and one for silence. An observer notes the category number every three seconds.

The ten categories of FIACS

GROUP	NO.	CATEGORY
Teacher talk: Indirect influence	1	Accepts feelings of pupils
	2	Praises or encourages
	3	Accepts or uses ideas of pupils
	4	Asks questions
Teacher talk: Direct influence	5	Lecturing / giving facts
	6	Giving directions
	7	Criticising or justifying authority
Pupil talk	8	Pupil talk: response
	9	Pupil talk: initiation
Silence	10	Silence or confusion

Categories 1 to 4 show **indirect influence** (the teacher encourages pupil participation), while categories 5 to 7 show **direct influence** (the teacher controls the class). The recorded numbers are placed in a 10 × 10 matrix to study the teaching pattern.

Thus FIACS is a scientific tool that helps a teacher become more indirect, democratic and effective.

Q9

~8 MARKS

"Throw light on the role of educational technology in modern educational practice."

ROLE OF ED-TECH

In modern practice, educational technology has changed the way teaching and learning take place by bringing computers, multimedia, the internet and smart tools into the classroom.

Role in modern educational practice

- **Effective teaching:** smart boards, projectors and videos make lessons clear and lively.
- **Individualised learning:** CAI and online lessons let each learner study at his or her own pace.
- **Wider reach:** online classes, MOOCs and recorded lectures take education to distant and rural areas.
- **Rich resources:** e-books, e-libraries and the internet give unlimited material to teachers and students.
- **Better evaluation:** online tests and instant results make assessment fast and fair.
- **Teacher training:** micro-teaching and recordings help teachers improve their skills.
- **Administration:** attendance, records and results are managed efficiently.

For example, during recent times online platforms like Zoom and Google Meet kept education running when schools were closed.

Hence educational technology now plays a central role in making modern education effective, flexible and accessible to all.

Q10

~8 MARKS

"What do you mean by audio-visual aids? Throw light on their importance."

AUDIO-VISUAL AIDS

Audio-visual aids are those teaching materials and equipment that appeal to the ears (audio) and the eyes (visual) of learners, and so make teaching more clear, interesting and effective.

Types of audio-visual aids

Audio aids

- Radio, tape recorder, audio clips.

Visual aids

- Charts, maps, models, pictures, blackboard.

Aids that work on both senses together (audio-visual) include television, films, computers and projectors.

Importance of audio-visual aids

- **Clear understanding:** they turn abstract ideas into concrete, visible form.
- **Interest and attention:** they make the lesson lively and hold pupils' attention.
- **Lasting memory:** what is seen and heard is remembered longer than what is only told.
- **Save time:** a single picture or model can explain more than many words.
- **Motivation:** they encourage active participation by learners.

According to **Edgar Dale's Cone of Experience**, direct, real and visual experiences give the most lasting learning, while purely verbal ones give the least.

Thus audio-visual aids are powerful tools that make teaching simple, interesting and memorable.

Q11

~8 MARKS

"Discuss the revolution in education brought about by computer technology."

COMPUTER REVOLUTION

Computer technology has brought a deep and lasting change (a revolution) in education by transforming how knowledge is delivered, accessed, stored and evaluated.

Ways computers have revolutionised education

- **From chalk to screen:** blackboard teaching has been supported by multimedia, smart boards and presentations.
- **Online and distance learning:** e-learning, MOOCs and virtual classrooms let anyone learn from anywhere.
- **Unlimited information:** the internet, e-books and digital libraries put a world of knowledge at the fingertips.
- **Self-paced learning:** Computer Assisted Instruction (CAI) adjusts to each learner's speed.
- **Easy evaluation:** online tests give quick, fair and instant results.
- **Better administration:** admissions, records and results are handled in minutes.
- **Global connection:** learners and teachers share ideas across the whole world.

For example, a student in a village can now study a course offered by a famous university through SWAYAM, something impossible before computers.

Thus computer technology has made education faster, wider, cheaper and more democratic, truly a revolution in learning.

Q12

~8 MARKS

"What is a storage device? Explain the various types of storage device."

STORAGE DEVICE

A storage device is a piece of hardware used to store, save and retrieve data and programs in a computer, either temporarily or permanently. Storage is divided into **primary (main) memory** and **secondary (auxiliary) memory**.

Primary memory

- **RAM (Random Access Memory):** temporary memory that holds data while the computer is working; its contents are lost when power goes off (volatile).
- **ROM (Read Only Memory):** permanent memory that stores the start-up instructions; its contents are not lost (non-volatile).

Secondary storage devices

Common secondary storage devices

DEVICE	DESCRIPTION	TYPICAL USE
Hard Disk (HDD)	Large internal magnetic disk, fixed in the computer.	Main long-term storage of OS, software and files.
SSD (Solid State Drive)	Chip-based drive with no moving parts; very fast.	Faster modern storage in laptops and PCs.
Pen Drive (USB)	Small portable flash device.	Carrying and sharing files between computers.
CD / DVD	Optical discs read by laser.	Storing music, films, software and backups.
Memory Card	Tiny flash card (SD card).	Storage in mobiles and cameras.
Cloud Storage	Online storage on remote servers (Google Drive, etc.).	Access and backup of data over the internet.

Thus storage devices keep our data safe and ready for use, ranging from fast temporary RAM to large permanent disks and modern cloud storage.



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